Zurich, August 31st 2019

Letter of Recommendation for Ararat Tonoyan

It is a pleasure to write a recommendation letter for Ararat Tonoyan. Ararat has been working with QuantNet on a free-lancing basis between February 8th 2019 and August 31st 2019.

QuantNet develops algorithmic trading strategies for the equity, futures and forex markets and applies scientific methods from diverse disciplines – mathematics, physics, computer science and statistics – including signal processing, pattern recognition and techniques from financial mathematics, machine learning, inferential statistics and data mining. The company interacts closely with its swiss shareholder IdeaLab Research GmbH, located in Zurich.

Ararat has been chosen among an array of candidates when the company planned integration of the QuantNet platform – a platform allowing data scientists located anywhere to develop remotely on our servers algorithms based on financial data and quantitative methods, run them and get rewards according to their performance – with Ethereum.

We immediately recognized the strong work ethics of Ararat, his programming skills and the desire to grow professionally even more in the fields of software development and blockchain technologies. Therefore we offered him the opportunity to closely interact with our developers and implement a Proof-of-Existence framework, namely a framework enabling us to set a timestamp on predictions submitted by users in order to be able to show publicly that predictions are not retroactively adjusted.

Ararat was involved in all tasks connected to the design and implementation of the Proof-of-Existence framework. From the very beginning Ararat worked closely with me and our developers, did a deep research for defining the best solution, produced a detailed plan and implemented the framework in our platform to the full satisfaction of the company. Ararat picked up the expertise required for developing his projects very quickly and actively proposed his own ideas where he saw opportunities for improvement.

Besides his project work Ararat was included in team meetings and discussions, during which he demonstrated his analytical capabilities, expertise into his work and ability to propose his own view on problems and possible solutions. He was taking part every day to a conference call involving me and other developers and company employees located in St Petersburg, Moscow, Kursk and Minsk. His behavior during the call was always flawless and he managed to get things done.

Moreover, given his skills in front-end development, he actively took part in the improvement of our web page and delivered a fast and efficient solution for the company blog, the internal time tracker employed to monitor the progress of the team members and the migration of the front-end side to React.

Ararat can explain very complicated matters in a clear and accessible way both in Russian and English, and he has documented publicly for the major russian portal Habr his work. As a software developer, he has shown that he can work very independently and keep attacking hard problems from various angles until they

finally yield. He has been a wonderful colleague who has worked very hard with his collaborators. He will be a great fit wherever quantitative insight is required.

As a contractor of QuantNet, Ararat has shown a high degree of initiative and responsibility and always acted in the best interest of the company.

Ararat decided to interrupt his collaboration on August 31st 2019 at his own wish, since the project reached a mature state and he would like to tackle new challenges. We have been lucky in working with him in the last year and wish him all the best and every success in his professional future.

Dr. Stefano Actis
Managing Director
IdeaLab Research Zurich